

Yu Qin

RESEARCH FELLOW, PHD IN ECONOMICS,

University of Nottingham, Nottingham, NG7 2RD, United Kingdom

✉ Yu.Qin1@nottingham.ac.uk | 🏠 <https://qinyu631-boop.github.io/>

Academic Appointment

Research Fellow

NOTTINGHAM UNIVERSITY BUSINESS SCHOOL

Nottingham, UK

2026 – Present

- ERC Advanced Grant Project: *Chinese Development (China 4E)*
- Principal Investigator: Prof. Dr. **Peter Ho**
- Conducting institutional analysis and fieldwork on Rural-Urban Transition in China.

Education

University of Southampton

PHD IN ECONOMICS

Southampton, UK

2021 - 2026

- Labour/ Environmental/ Development/ Health Economics
- Supervisor: Prof. **Corrado Giuliatti** & Prof. **Jackie Wahba**

University of Queensland

MSC OF ECONOMICS

Brisbane, Australia

2018 - 2020

- Applied Microeconomics, Political Economy
- Supervisor: Prof. **Haishan Yuan**

Central South University

BACHELOR OF ENERGY SCIENCE AND POWER ENGINEERING

Changsha, China

2013 - 2017

- Automation, Hydro Mechanics, Heat Transfer Theory
- Honors thesis/undergrad research advisor: Prof. **Ying Yang**

Research Interests

Environmental Economics • Labour Economics • Migration Economics • Applied Microeconomics

Research Experience

- 2025.2-2025.8 **Research Assistant**, University of Southampton
- 2023.7 **Responsible Management Education Symposium**, University of Winchester
- 2020.9-2021.5 **Visiting Scholar**, China Academy of Science
- 2019.4-2019.12 **Research Assistant**, University of Queensland

Awards, Fellowships, & Grants

- 2021 - 2025 **Visiting Fellowship**, University of Southampton GBP 3,000
- 2020 **2020 Dean's Honor Roll**, University of Queensland
- 2017 **National Self-Exploration Project**, Central South University CNY 10,000
- 2015 **National Scholarship**, Central South University CNY 2,000

Presentations

INVITED TALKS & CONFERENCE

Summer 2023. **Migration and Environment Regulation** . Invited talk: PRME SYMPOSIUM, Winchester, UK.

Summer 2024. **Migration Decision and Environment Pollution** . Invited talk: IISA & China Academy of Science, Beijing, China.

Teaching Experience

- Fall 2024 **Introduction to Econometrics**, Teaching Assistant
- 2024-2025 **MSc Dissertation**, Supervisor/Teaching Assistant
- Spr. 2024 **Economics with Data**, Teaching Assistant
- 2023-2024 **Foundations of Microeconomics**, Teaching Assistant
- 2022-2023 **Dissertation Drop-in Help Sessions**, Supervisor/Teaching Assistant
- Spr. 2023 **Applied Econometrics**, Teaching Assistant
- Spr. 2023 **Industrial Economics**, Teaching Assistant
- Fall 2022 **Crises of the 21st Century**, Teaching Assistant
- Spr. 2022 **Introduction to International Relations**, Teaching Assistant
- Fall 2021 **A (Dis) United Kingdom? Myth and Reality in British Politics**, Teaching Assistant

Quantitative Skills

Econometric Methods: Proficient in causal inference with panel data; experience with time-series data.

Statistical Software: Proficient in **Stata**; experience with **R** and **Python**.

Geographic Information Systems: **ArcGIS Pro** for spatial data & Satellite data.

Research Papers

MANUSCRIPTS AND WORKING PAPERS

Research Papers

REVISE & RESUBMIT

Host Country Language and School Integration of Immigrant Students.

With Michael Vlassopoulos and Jackline Wahba.

R&R at *Journal of Population Economics*

Using PISA data from 16 OECD countries and an instrumental-variable strategy based on age at arrival and linguistic distance, we estimate the causal impact of host-country language proficiency on immigrant students' school integration. A one-standard-deviation increase in reading proficiency significantly improves social integration and reduces bullying exposure.

JOB MARKET PAPER

Breathing Easy, Retiring Early? Effects of Air Pollution on Retirement Age Expectations: Evidence from China.

With Dingzhi Chen

Under Review at *Journal of Environmental Economics and Management*

Using longitudinal survey data merged with satellite-derived pollution measures, this paper examines how deteriorating air quality shapes forward-looking labour supply decisions. The results show that higher pollution significantly lowers expected retirement age, particularly among rural workers, women, and individuals in physically demanding jobs. Additional evidence suggests that health insurance coverage, financial resources, and green infrastructure mediate the

response, indicating that perceived health risks and institutional protection jointly shape labour supply expectations.

WORKING PAPERS

Following Cleaner Air: Air Pollution and Destination Choice Across Mobility and Migration in China.

With Dingzhi Chen

Invited Resubmission at *Regional Science and Urban Economics*

This paper examines how air pollution shapes destination choice using high-frequency inter-city mobility data from the Gaode Migration Big Data Platform and bilateral migration data from the Chinese Population Census. Exploiting destination–origin thermal inversion differences as an instrument for PM_{2.5} exposure, we show that pollution significantly reduces destination planning, realized mobility, and long-run migration, with stronger effects on planning than on realized mobility. The findings suggest that pollution avoidance begins before travel occurs and that studies based only on realized mobility underestimate behavioural responses to environmental risk.

Green Remittances: How Migration Shapes Green Behaviours in Rural China.

With Dingzhi Chen and Fengtian Yang

Submitted to *World Development*

This paper studies how migration influences the environmental behaviour of rural households. While current migration can weaken daily pro-environmental practices through household fragmentation, return migration improves recycling and waste sorting, consistent with the transmission of environmental norms and skills acquired in urban areas. Social capital and local green infrastructure strengthen these relationships.

When Reading is Hard: Reading Proficiency and Generative AI Use among Immigrant Students.

With Dingzhi Chen

Using PISA 2025 data on first-generation immigrant students across OECD countries, this paper studies how language proficiency shapes the adoption and use of generative AI. Exploiting variation in age at arrival and linguistic distance to instrument reading proficiency, we find that weaker language proficiency increases AI use for summarising, preliminary research, and writing, while having little effect on its use for general learning. The findings suggest that generative AI can serve as a task-specific substitute for constrained human capital, with adoption driven not only by technological capability but also by the need to overcome skill limitations.

When Models Disagree: Measuring Macroeconomic and Financial Uncertainty.

With Fengtian Yang and Dingzhi Chen

This paper develops new measures of macroeconomic and financial uncertainty by combining forecasts from four heterogeneous model families, including factor-augmented, regularized, and neural-network approaches. Using an expanding-window pseudo-out-of-sample framework, we decompose predictive risk into within-model uncertainty and cross-model disagreement. The latter predicts subsequent forecast errors beyond within-model variance and exhibits distinct cyclical dynamics, providing a new measure of model uncertainty in macroeconomic and financial forecasting.

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

AI Washing and Recruitment Strategies: Evidence from China.

With Dingzhi Chen

Using approximately seven million online job postings matched to publicly listed firms in China, this paper examines how corporate AI washing shapes firms' recruitment strategies. We investigate whether discrepancies between firms' AI-related claims and their underlying AI capabilities translate into changes in labour demand, including hiring intensity, occupational composition, skill requirements, and offered wages.

When the Air Gets Dirty: Recruitment Responses in China's Listed Companies.

With Dingzhi Chen

Drawing on millions of online job postings combined with firm- and city-level environmental data, this paper investigates how recruitment strategies adjust when pollution rises. Firms reduce advertised wages for higher-skilled positions and expand hiring for non-managerial roles, consistent with shifting labour demand under environmental stress.

POLICY BRIEFS

Language Proficiency is Central to Immigrant Children's Integration at School.

With Michael Vlassopoulos and Jackline Wahba.

Policy Brief, ESRC Centre for Population Change Connecting Generations, UKRI, 2026.

Integration Starts with Language: Immigrant Children across OECD Countries.

With Michael Vlassopoulos and Jackline Wahba.

Policy Insights, Population Europe, 2026.

References

Prof. Corrado Giulietti

C.GIULIETTI@SOTON.AC.UK

Supervisor

University of Southampton

Southampton, UK

Prof. Jackie Wahba

J.WAHBA@SOTON.AC.UK

Supervisor

University of Southampton

Southampton, UK

Prof. Michael Vlassopoulos

M.VLASSOPOULOS@SOTON.AC.UK

Tutor

University of Southampton

Southampton, UK